4.1. INCLUSIVE PLAYGROUNDS (URBAN PLANNER POSITION, ASTANA, KAZAKHSTAN 2022)

As part of UNICEF's Play Spaces for All initiative, our project team was **funded by UNICEF** from November 2021 to March 2022.

Initially, we examined global best practices and Kazakhstan's current play spaces. As a result of this dual approach, we were able **to identify successful models worldwide and understand the local context**. Playgrounds **do not cater** to all children, including those with disabilities, despite efforts toward inclusivity.

The next step was to explore Kazakhstan's **legislative framework** for playgrounds and inclusion. Based on our analysis, **it was clear where improvements needed to be made.** We used this understanding to craft practical and compliant recommendations.

Based on this knowledge, **we developed standard solutions.** Prototypes provided clear guidelines for planning, designing, and implementing accessible and safe playgrounds. Playing and enjoying ourselves was our goal for all children, regardless of their abilities.

In support of our mission, **we hosted an online forum.** Kazakhstan's play spaces were discussed by government officials, educators, parents, and international experts. Inclusion was promoted through the exchange of ideas and community involvement.

This project **culminated in a methodological guide displayed here.** The document offers policymakers and community leaders practical strategies based on our research, legislative analysis, and solutions. Anyone involved in creating inclusive play spaces will find it valuable.

My role was to research and manage the project.

This report has 38 pages. This project was developed in Russian and Kazakh.

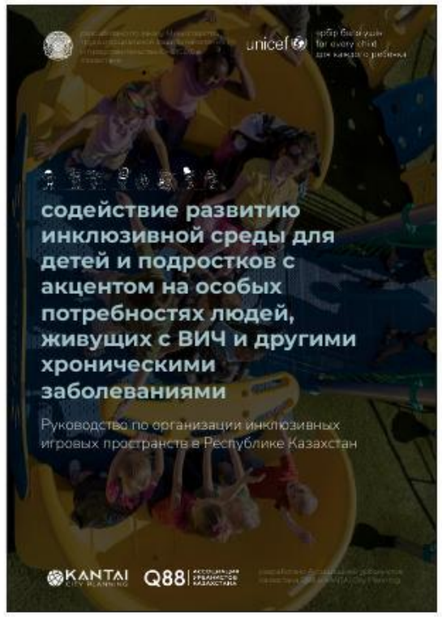


Figure 4.1: Front page of the document



Figure 4.2: These three pages show the principles and main planning and design principles of inclusive playground development

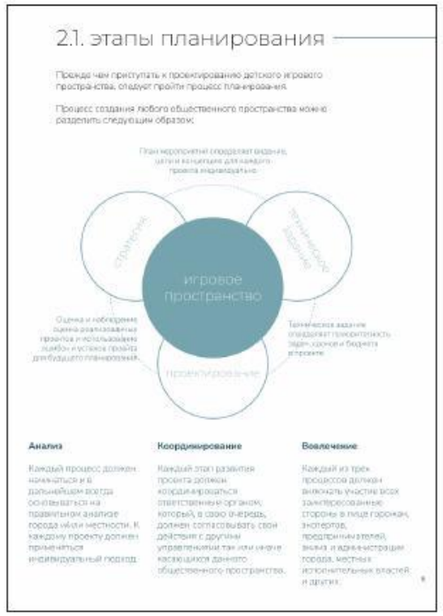


Figure 4.3: These two pages show the planning and design framework

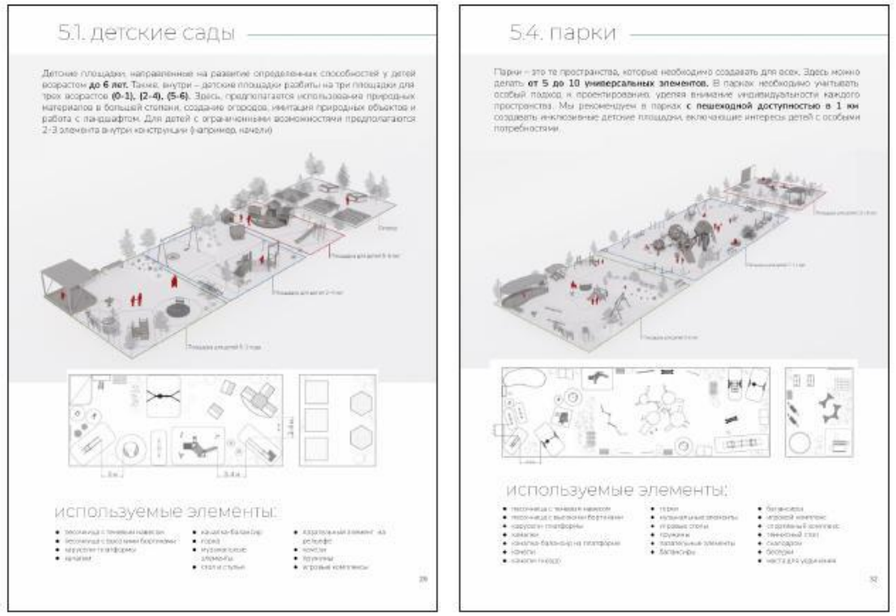


Figure 4.4: These two pages show the design prototypes for kindergarten and park playgrounds